EXPERT, STEP 21

One spreadsheet. Three guardrails.

Can the report still be written if the source stays untouched?

```
# the real run, 2 Nov 2026, macOS 27.0.1
Guardrails OFF
Guardrails ON
```

THE JOB

Count the shipment rows and save a report.

THE TEST

Run the same four commands with the guardrails off and on.

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Protect the original

The command tried to append a line to a disposable copy of the CSV.

```
# guardrails off
append to CSV: exit 0
CSV unchanged: False
# guardrails on
append to CSV: exit 1
demo: $TMP/shipments.csv: Operation not permitted
CSV unchanged: True
# $TMP: the temporary folder, path shortened
```

GUARDRAILS OFF

The append succeeded.

GUARDRAILS ON

The append failed. The CSV fingerprint stayed the same.

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Give it the exact path

A dummy private note sat outside the output folder. The command knew where it was.

```
# guardrails off
read dummy note by exact path: exit 0
dummy note
# guardrails on
read dummy note by exact path: exit 1
cat: $TMP/private-note.txt: Operation not permitted
# $TMP: the temporary folder, path shortened
```

GUARDRAILS OFF

The command read the note.

GUARDRAILS ON

The read failed. This rule protected that note, not the whole Mac.

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Test the connection

A harmless endpoint listened on the same Mac. The request carried no shipment data.

```
# guardrails off
request local endpoint: exit 0
endpoint reached
# guardrails on
request local endpoint: exit 7
curl: (7) Failed to connect to 127.0.0.1 port 51482 after
0 ms: Couldn't connect to server
```

GUARDRAILS OFF

The endpoint answered.

GUARDRAILS ON

The request failed. No internet upload was tested.

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Keep the useful result

The report still said 198 shipment rows with the guardrails on.

```
# guardrails off
count rows and write report: exit 0
Shipment rows: 198
# guardrails on
count rows and write report: exit 0
Shipment rows: 198
```

TRY IT

Run the demo from the AI Starter Kit on a Mac.

WHAT THIS SHOWS

The commands ran under a policy. No model chose them.